Wayne Kim

Interaction Designer

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I design physical-digital interactions and prototype them with sensors, light, motion, and screens, using Arduino, CAD, and code, then test them with people. Seven years in design research at Designit and startups backed by a16z, YC, and SoftBank, then a Master's in Interaction Design at CIID.

EXPERIENCE

Independent | Interaction Designer
Sept 2025 - Present

Los Angeles, CA

- Toilet Paper Elevator: wired a Hall effect sensor, e-paper screen, and LiPo battery to an Arduino; modeled and 3D-printed the enclosure in Fusion 360 over five iterations; tested the screen states with people and revised them.
- room_tone: light, motion, and music cues that nudge a break one layer at a time, run by a Python state machine.
- Two client projects with CIID, for a medical technology company and an AI translation company, under NDA.

Glorify | Senior Design Researcher
Feb 2023 - Feb 2024

Los Angeles, CA

- Turned leadership's doubts about community into one testable hypothesis, then ran a 2-week prototype diary study with 82 people in their real small groups. 65% were still active at week two.
- Turned the findings into three design principles; leadership launched Glorify Groups and committed 3 of 4 pods. By 2025 it had 1.8M+ users and 20% of daily actives.
- Built the research practice and grew the team from one researcher to three.

Designit | Design Researcher
Aug 2021 - Jan 2023

Remote / New York, NY

- Led end-to-end mixed-methods research and usability testing for Fortune 500 clients.
- Facilitated a 3-day, 60-person workshop that turned C-suite priorities into product strategy; led speculative futures work.

Independent | Designer and Researcher
Jun 2020 - Aug 2021

- Research and design for Y Combinator companies, including Govly, Rally.Video, and Measured.

RaiseMe | UX Strategist
Dec 2017 - Jun 2020

San Francisco, CA

- Redesigned how 330+ college partners received enrollment data, replacing a manual export with automatic reports and helping retain 90%+ of revenue at risk.

Reed College | Assistant Dean of Admission
Jan 2015 - Nov 2017

Portland, OR

- Designed the Junior Scholars program from 0 to 1, then redesigned its outreach to grow applicants 8x (23 to 187).

EDUCATION

Copenhagen Institute of Interaction Design (CIID) | Master's in Interaction Design
Sept 2024 - Aug 2025

- Linee (team): coded the stepper motor and LEDs for a tactile wall timekeeper that gives each planned hour a soft knock, with no alarms or screens.
- Living.fm (team): trained an ESP32 camera vision model and coded the state machine that decides when a small speaker comments, and when it stays quiet.
- Mirrored Canvas (team): face tracking in FaceOSC and Processing that turns expressions into live projected visuals.
- Bureau of Sanctioned Sketching (final project): a card game that gives adults permission to draw, playtested with people.

Los Angeles Cleantech Incubator (LACI) | Product Design and Development Fellowship
Oct 2026 - Dec 2026

- SolidWorks modeling and assemblies (CSWA prep), capstone team project, OSHA 10.

Colby College | B.A. in Sociology
Sept 2010 - May 2014

SKILLS

Interaction design: physical-digital touchpoints, light, motion, and tactile cues, device states, small e-paper screens

Prototyping: Arduino, ESP32, sensors (Hall effect, camera), LEDs, stepper motors, 3D printing, laser cutting, Wizard-of-Oz

Research: usability testing, prototype diary studies, interviews, playtesting, synthesis

Tools: Figma, Fusion 360, SolidWorks, Python, Processing, TouchDesigner, Teachable Machine, Cursor, Claude Code